

Star Trek fans rejoice

Game publishers Namco Bandai and Paramount Pictures announced recently that Star Trek: The Video Game will be released on April 23, 2013.

John McAfee arrested

John McAfee, the founder of McAfee who was on the run after being identified as a "person of interest" in a murder trial was finally arrested in Guatemala.



Zync Z5

superior to the competition. The camera on this device is really good for daylight shooting.

Verdict

The Best Buy was awarded to Spice Stellar Horizon. It hasn't gone the copycat route and the device has its own unique look and feel. The 5 MP camera takes good photos and the overall look and feel of the device is nice. Its stock Android for the most part with tweaks that don't really hamper the user experience. In terms of raw performance too it is better than its competitors. The addition of on-board security apps is a good welcome and the only drawback to the device is that its pointy edges may not appeal to all.

₹20,000 and above

This is the category where companies bring out their big guns, their flagship devices.

You get what you pay for and that is clearly evident with the contenders in this category. A person buying one of these devices clearly knows what he's getting into. The competition is stiff.

Build and Usability

The Samsung Galaxy Note is still available in the market and it's still priced at a premium at ₹29,990 (at launch it was priced at ₹33,690). It was the device to start the phablet revolution and is still a worthy contender in this competition. It has a larger 5.3-inch display with a resolution of 1280x800. Under the hood it has a dual-core 1.4 GHz processor and 1 GB of RAM. In its benchmark scores today, it comes last on the list but the device ahead of it doesn't have that big a lead. It's still a good phablet to look at and has the S-Pen whose compatibility app

library has expanded since its debut. Though plasticky, its overall build is still quite good.

Taking an already successful product and improving upon it gives us the Samsung Galaxy Note II. It is a little bigger than its predecessor with a 5.5-inch display and the design of the phablet has a lot more curves adding to the elegance as well as the style. The device does have a glossy plasticky finish to it that reduces the grip. The S-Pen makes an appearance here as well – it's bigger, more comfortable and packs in more utility. It is really slim as well and you can't help but say "wow!" when you hold the device for the first time.

Next in line we have the LG Optimus VU. The first thing you will notice about the device is that it has a very squarish design thanks to the 4:3 aspect ratio and this isn't a good thing at all. It makes typing a pain, it's uncomfortable to hold and one hand operation is just frustrating. This is the only device on our entire list that doesn't give users access to the battery and you have a SIM card slot that rests on the side of the device similar to the iPhone. The placement of the camera too is in a corner making it easy to cover with your finger if you hold it in landscape mode. The design of the VU is the least appealing of them all. Last but not least, we have the Lenovo K860. This device puts the phrase; don't judge a book by its cover to the test. It looks like a simple rectangular candy bar but is very comfortable to hold

and has the best one-handed operation in this premium list. The power button and the volume rocker buttons are a tad smaller than we'd like though. The screen is 5-inches and feels just about right. It isn't a beast like the Note II nor is it all over the place like the Optimus VU. The simple look may not appeal to all, but we think in this case, simplicity is the best.

Features and Performance

Being a first generation device, the Samsung Galaxy Note can be upgraded to Android 4.0 bringing it up to speed with the competition. The S-Pen is its most outstanding feature apart from the fact that the device is really smooth. The S-Pen is really useful especially if you are a creative person who likes to draw or paint or simply annotate images. Some of its features may seem out-dated when compared to its successor but that doesn't discount the fact that it is a great Android



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